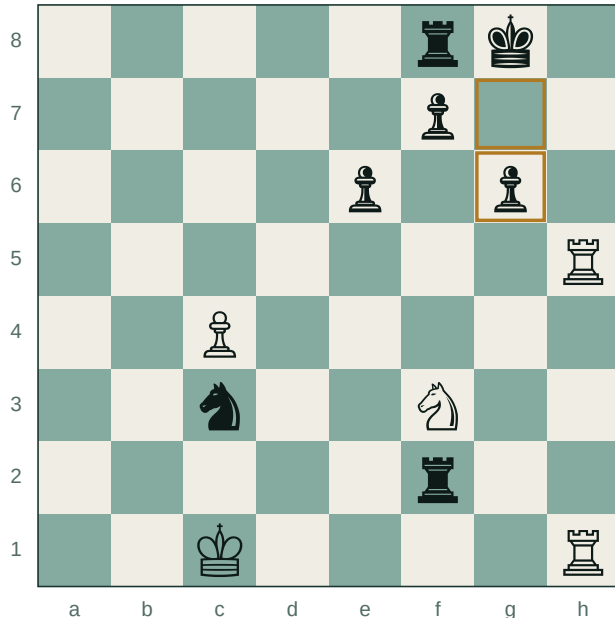


Deflection tactics: White, move 38

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 37...g6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Rh8+ Kg7 39. R1h7+ Kf6 40. Rxf8

38.Rh8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **38...Kg7**.

39.R1h7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **39...Kf6**.

40.Rxf8 The rook captures the rook on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: knight on c3 and rook on f2. Check for tactical protection.